THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which is an example of resistance by a coastal queen? 1

(a) Rani Lakshmibai **(b)** Begum Hazrat Mahal
(c) Rani Abbakka **(d)** Rani Durgavati

2. Which statement best captures the 'drain of wealth'? 1

(a) Free trade
(b) Gifts
(c) Revenue and profits flowing from India without equal return
(d) Gold coming in

3. A village loses its council and gets a distant court. This reflects 1

(a) tradition **(b)** centralisation under colonial rule
(c) democracy **(d)** decentralisation

4. A text calls the Great Famine 'man-made'. The argument is 1

(a) trade **(b)** rain only
(c) god only **(d)** policy failures worsened it

5. A rebel says 'we fight to save our faith and kingdom.' This reflects which cause of 1857? 1

(a) Telegraph **(b)** Religious and political discontent
(c) Tea **(d)** Railway fares

6. Which would NOT be a reason for the Company's success? 1

(a) Disciplined troops **(b)** Strong Indian unity
(c) Naval power **(d)** Rivalries among rulers

7. A British officer writes 'Indians are to be Indian in blood but English in taste'. He supports 1

(a) Gandhi **(b)** Tipu
(c) Macaulay's education aim **(d)** Dalhousie

8. A historian calls 1857 'the First War of Independence', another calls it 'mutiny'. This shows 1

(a) facts never exist **(b)** no rebellion
(c) no sources **(d)** interpretations differ

9. The Santhal and Indigo revolts differ in that 1

(a) one was in 1957
(b) one was in Delhi
(c) one was against moneylenders and the other against planters
(d) both ended British rule

10. What was a major difference between 1857 and earlier revolts? 1

(a) Smaller area **(b)** No leaders
(c) Wider geographic and social spread **(d)** No violence

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did 1857 change British policy? 2

12. What does the Colachel victory show? 2

13. What does the tax-in-famine example show about the Company's priorities? 2

14. Why are women like Abbakka and Lakshmibai important to this story? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the argument that colonial rule had some unintended benefits. 3

16. Examine why Awadh's annexation angered many. 3

17. Explain the role of the English East India Company's charter in its rise. 3

OR

Case: A famine kills one-third of the population but taxes are still collected. Name the event and comment. 3

18. Interpret: 'Railways were laid with Indian money.' What does it reveal? 3

OR

Assess the effect of the Inquisition on Goa's society. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Discuss the extent to which colonial economic policy was responsible for poverty and famines. 5

OR

Discuss the argument 'colonialism caused more harm than good' using evidence. 5

20. Compare the nature of Portuguese, Dutch, French and British expansion in India. 5

OR

How should historians use records written by colonial officers? Illustrate with the Bengal famine or 1857. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks